Project Report

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- **Course Code:** CSE0001
- **Course Title:** Digital Literacy

Introduction

In this project, I took on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador at VIT Bhopal. My primary goal was to create a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio to guide my peers through the essentials of the modern digital landscape. Over five modules, I explored visual design, professional networking, coding collaboration, email etiquette, and cybersecurity. This report documents my journey in building these resources and my reflections on becoming a more responsible digital citizen.

Task 1 Write-up: Digital Literacy Awareness

For this task, I designed a one-page infographic using **Canva**. I focused on three main areas: defining digital literacy, essential tools for engineering students, and basic safe internet practices.

The design process was quite eye-opening. I chose a clean, blue-and-white professional theme to make the information easy to digest for my batchmates. One thing I found interesting was how difficult it is to simplify complex topics like "Cyber Hygiene" into just a few bullet points. I had to prioritize clarity over detail to ensure the infographic remained a quick-reference guide rather than a dense document. This taught me that effective digital communication is as much about what you leave out as what you include.

Task 2 Write-up: Student Digital Portfolio

Building a professional online presence is a key requirement for any modern engineer. I set up and updated profiles on **LinkedIn, GitHub, and Kaggle**. On GitHub, I created a special profile README to introduce myself to the developer community , while on LinkedIn, I updated my education details to reflect my journey at VIT Bhopal.

I chose these platforms because they represent the "Big Three" for tech students: LinkedIn for networking, GitHub for version control and projects,

and Kaggle for data science practice. Over the next four years, I plan to use LinkedIn to connect with industry mentors and GitHub to host every major project I code. Seeing my professional identity start to take shape online makes the transition from student to professional feel much more tangible.

Task 3 Write-up: Coding & Collaboration

This task was split into two parts: technical practice and team collaboration. First, I used **HackerRank** to complete the "Solve Me First" challenge in Python. Second, I built a **Google Form** titled "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" with five targeted questions to test my peers' knowledge.

Practicing on HackerRank showed me how standardized coding tests work, which is great preparation for future internship screenings. On the other hand, building the Google Form was a lesson in data collection. These tools are incredibly helpful for academic life because they allow for seamless collaboration on group projects. I realized that being "digitally literate" isn't just about coding; it’s about knowing which cloud tool to use to get a group task done efficiently.

Task 4 Write-up: Professional Communication

For this module, I drafted two professional emails: one asking a professor for an assignment extension and another expressing interest in a summer internship. I also compiled a "Social Media Do's and Don'ts" checklist to help students maintain a positive digital footprint.

A key learning from this task was the importance of "Netiquette." I once read about a student who lost a job offer because of an unprofessional "reply-all" email that was meant to be private. This scenario taught me that every digital interaction leaves a trail. Using a clear subject line and a respectful tone isn't just about being polite—it’s about protecting your professional reputation. I now double-check my "To" field and subject lines before hitting send every single time.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness

I researched a case study on **UPI/QR Code Fraud**, a common scam where victims are tricked into entering their PIN to "receive" money. Along with this, I created a safety checklist that highlights the **National Cyber Crime Helpline (1930)**.

What surprised me most during my research was how scammers use "social engineering"—psychological manipulation—rather than just technical hacking. It's scary how a simple sense of urgency can make someone forget basic security rules. One habit I am changing immediately is my UPI usage: I will never scan a QR code sent by a stranger, as I now fully understand that receiving money never requires a PIN or a scan.

Conclusion

This project has shifted my perspective on what it means to be a "Digital Ambassador." It is not just about knowing how to use apps, but about using them safely, professionally, and ethically. I feel much more confident in my ability to manage my digital footprint and guide my peers toward better online habits. These 100 marks were just the beginning; the repository I built will serve as the foundation for my professional career over the next four years.

References

- **Canva** (Design Tool): canva.com
- **GitHub** (Portfolio/Repo): https://github.com/shreyansh25mei1008-lang
- **LinkedIn** (Networking): https://www.linkedin.com/in/shreyansh-gupta-2367b73bb/
- **HackerRank** (Coding): https://www.hackerrank.com/profile/shreyansh_25mei1
- **National Cyber Crime Portal**: cybercrime.gov.in